INCH-POUND

A-A-54855
16 April 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

GAUZE, ABSORBENT, STERILE, COMPRESSED

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-G-3379B which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers a compressed sterile absorbent gauze suitable for use as a surgical dressing.

Salient characteristics:

Shall be a sterile absorbent gauze suitable for use as a surgical dressing. The gauze shall meet the requirements for USP Absorbent Gauze Type III. The paper wrapper shall be glassine or sulfite paper weighing not less than 25 pounds, basis 24 by 36 inches (500 sheets)

Each piece of gauze shall measure 18 by 36 inches minimum before being folded and compressed.

Each piece of gauze shall be individually folded, with 18 inches long edges on the inside, to a size of 4 inches by 18 inches, and folded again to a size of 4 inches by 9 inches. Raw edges shall be on the inside. This pad shall then be flat folded and compressed in such a manner that two such gauzes shall be capable of fitting a standard commercial container. As an alternate to flat folding the pad from the 4 inch by 9 inch size, the pad may be accordion folded from the 4 inch by 18 inch size and then compressed as described herein. There shall be no raw edges exposed.

Each compressed gauze shall be individually enclosed in a glassine paper wrapper and sealed. The wrapper shall be constructed and sealed so that sterility is maintained until the wrapper is open. The glassine wrapper shall bear the legend: "STERILE UNLESS WRAPPER IS DAMAGED OR OPENED".

AMSC N/A FSC 6510

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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The compressed gauze shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the Pharmacopeia of the United States (USP) for purified cotton, gauze, surgical dressings, and related material, using biological indicators conforming to AAMI-ST19.

Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the USP.

Workmanship. The compressed gauzes shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing two (2) individually wrapped sterile gauzes, as specified, constitutes one unit. The individual package shall be a sealed peel-open type container capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless the package is damaged or opened.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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Sampling for examination and tests. Sampling for examination and tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-4. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one package of two (2) gauzes.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered material. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6510-00-202-4000	GAUZE, ABSORBENT, STERILE, COMPRESSED.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6510-0855

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-54855	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 16 April 1993

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
GAUZE, ABSORBENT, STERILE, COMPRESSED

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (*Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.*)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

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